

Prompt Engineering — 100 Multiple Choice Questions

Foundations of Prompt Engineering & Core Principles of Effective Prompting

Instructions: Choose the best answer for each question.

Part A — Foundations of Prompt Engineering (1–50)

1. What is prompt engineering?

- A. Designing computer hardware
- B. Writing instructions to guide an AI model toward a desired output
- C. Training a database
- D. Developing an operating system

Answer: B

2. What is a prompt?

- A. A programming compiler
- B. An instruction or input given to an AI model
- C. A database table
- D. A network protocol

Answer: B

3. What is the primary goal of prompt engineering?

- A. Increase internet speed
- B. Generate more computer memory
- C. Obtain useful and relevant outputs from AI systems
- D. Replace operating systems

Answer: C

4. Which technology is most closely associated with modern prompt engineering?

- A. Generative AI
- B. Blockchain only
- C. File compression
- D. Computer networking

Answer: A

5. Generative AI is primarily designed to:

- A. Only store information
- B. Generate new content based on input
- C. Repair hardware
- D. Increase CPU speed

Answer: B

6. Which is an example of a generative AI task?

- A. Generating an email draft
- B. Formatting a hard disk

- C. Installing RAM
- D. Connecting a keyboard

Answer: A

7. Which of the following can be generated using generative AI?

- A. Text
- B. Images
- C. Code
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

8. A good prompt should generally be:

- A. Ambiguous
- B. Extremely vague
- C. Clear and specific
- D. Unrelated to the task

Answer: C

9. Which component tells the AI what you want it to accomplish?

- A. Intent
- B. Hardware
- C. Operating system
- D. File extension

Answer: A

10. Why is context important in a prompt?

- A. It provides relevant background information
- B. It increases RAM
- C. It changes the computer's processor
- D. It removes the need for instructions

Answer: A

11. Which prompt is more specific?

- A. "Write something."
- B. "Write a 150-word professional email requesting leave."
- C. "Write."
- D. "Email."

Answer: B

12. What does "output format" refer to?

- A. The physical shape of the computer
- B. How the AI response should be structured or presented
- C. The internet connection
- D. The model's hardware

Answer: B

13. Which is an example of specifying an output format?

- A. "Answer somehow."
- B. "Give the answer as a table with three columns."
- C. "Do it."
- D. "Think."

Answer: B

14. What is an AI-enabled workflow?

- A. A workflow that uses AI as part of one or more tasks
- B. A computer manufacturing process
- C. A networking protocol
- D. A database backup

Answer: A

15. Prompt engineering can be useful in:

- A. Academics
- B. Software development
- C. Professional communication
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

16. Which is an academic use of prompt engineering?

- A. Creating study questions
- B. Repairing a monitor
- C. Installing a printer
- D. Increasing disk capacity

Answer: A

17. Which is a technical use of prompt engineering?

- A. Generating code explanations
- B. Cleaning a keyboard
- C. Replacing a battery
- D. Connecting a mouse

Answer: A

18. Which is a professional use of prompt engineering?

- A. Drafting business emails
- B. Changing a laptop screen
- C. Installing RAM
- D. Replacing a hard drive

Answer: A

19. What is a prompt library?

- A. A collection of reusable prompts
- B. A computer programming language
- C. A physical library only

D. A database server

Answer: A

20. What is the main benefit of a prompt library?

- A. Reusability
- B. Increased CPU speed
- C. More RAM
- D. Better internet connectivity

Answer: A

21. What is a reusable prompt?

- A. A prompt designed to be used repeatedly with appropriate changes
- B. A prompt that can only be used once
- C. A computer command
- D. A database query only

Answer: A

22. What is a prompt pack?

- A. A collection of prompts designed for related tasks
- B. A hardware package
- C. An operating system
- D. A programming compiler

Answer: A

23. Which is an example of a prompt pack?

- A. 20 prompts for generating marketing content
- B. A keyboard package
- C. A laptop charger
- D. A collection of computer drivers

Answer: A

24. Why should reusable prompts contain variables or placeholders?

- A. To make them adaptable to different situations
- B. To make them harder to understand
- C. To prevent reuse
- D. To increase computer speed

Answer: A

25. Which is a useful placeholder?

- A. [TOPIC]
- B. @@@@ only
- C. ??? only
- D. ERROR

Answer: A

26. What is prompt iteration?

- A. Repeatedly improving a prompt based on the quality of its outputs
- B. Deleting all prompts
- C. Installing AI software
- D. Restarting the computer

Answer: A

27. Why is iteration important?

- A. The first prompt may not produce the desired result
- B. It always makes the AI faster
- C. It increases RAM
- D. It eliminates the need for context

Answer: A

28. What should you do if an AI response is too general?

- A. Add more relevant context and specific requirements
- B. Remove all instructions
- C. Give no context
- D. Restart the computer

Answer: A

29. What should you do if an AI response uses the wrong format?

- A. Explicitly specify the desired format
- B. Remove the prompt
- C. Give less information
- D. Ignore the response

Answer: A

30. Which is an example of a structured practice environment?

- A. A platform where students repeatedly create and test prompts
- B. A computer repair shop
- C. A printer
- D. A keyboard

Answer: A

31. Why are learning resources useful for prompt engineering?

- A. They provide concepts, examples and practice opportunities
- B. They increase CPU performance
- C. They replace the AI model
- D. They remove the need for learning

Answer: A

32. Which activity is most useful for learning prompt engineering?

- A. Writing and testing different prompts
- B. Memorizing computer brands
- C. Changing wallpapers
- D. Installing games

Answer: A

33. Which statement about prompt engineering is correct?

- A. It is only useful for programmers
- B. It can be useful across many domains
- C. It is only useful for image generation
- D. It is unrelated to AI

Answer: B

34. Prompt engineering can help students:

- A. Summarize concepts
- B. Generate practice questions
- C. Explain difficult topics
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

35. Prompt engineering can help software developers:

- A. Explain code
- B. Generate code examples
- C. Debug problems
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

36. Which factor most directly improves prompt clarity?

- A. Specific instructions
- B. Random wording
- C. Missing context
- D. Contradictory requirements

Answer: A

37. What does intent mean in prompting?

- A. The desired purpose or goal of the task
- B. The AI's hardware
- C. The model's programming language
- D. The internet connection

Answer: A

38. Which prompt clearly communicates intent?

- A. "Explain."
- B. "Explain photosynthesis to a Class 8 student using a simple example."
- C. "Do something about photosynthesis."
- D. "Photosynthesis."

Answer: B

39. Which is NOT normally a benefit of prompt libraries?

- A. Reusability

- B. Consistency
- C. Faster task setup
- D. Guaranteed perfect answers

Answer: D

40. A prompt template is useful because it:

- A. Provides a repeatable structure
- B. Automatically guarantees correctness
- C. Replaces human judgment
- D. Eliminates the need for testing

Answer: A

41. Which is an example of a prompt template?

- A. "Summarize [ARTICLE] in [NUMBER] bullet points."
- B. "Summarize."
- C. "AI."
- D. "Do it."

Answer: A

42. What is one limitation of generative AI?

- A. It can sometimes produce incorrect information
- B. It never generates text
- C. It cannot follow instructions
- D. It cannot process prompts

Answer: A

43. Why should AI-generated information sometimes be verified?

- A. AI outputs can contain errors
- B. AI never produces information
- C. Verification makes prompts shorter
- D. Verification increases CPU speed

Answer: A

44. What is the relationship between prompt quality and output quality?

- A. Clearer prompts can often produce more relevant outputs
- B. Prompt quality never matters
- C. Poor prompts always produce perfect answers
- D. They are completely unrelated

Answer: A

45. Which is an example of prompt-based automation?

- A. Using a reusable prompt to generate standardized reports
- B. Manually typing every report from scratch
- C. Replacing a laptop battery
- D. Installing a printer

Answer: A

46. Which tool category can use prompts to generate images?

- A. Generative image AI
- B. Spreadsheet software only
- C. File compression software
- D. Antivirus software

Answer: A

47. Which tool category can use prompts to generate code?

- A. AI coding assistants
- B. Calculator only
- C. File explorer
- D. Disk management

Answer: A

48. A prompt library is particularly useful when:

- A. Similar tasks are performed repeatedly
- B. No tasks are repeated
- C. AI is never used
- D. Instructions are unnecessary

Answer: A

49. What should a good prompt avoid?

- A. Relevant context
- B. Clear requirements
- C. Unnecessary ambiguity
- D. Desired output format

Answer: C

50. Which statement best describes prompt engineering?

- A. It is only about asking questions
- B. It involves designing and refining instructions to guide AI toward useful outputs
- C. It is the same as computer hardware engineering
- D. It eliminates human involvement

Answer: B

Part B — Core Principles of Effective Prompting (51–100)

51. Which is a core principle of effective prompting?

- A. Clarity
- B. Ambiguity
- C. Randomness
- D. Missing context

Answer: A

52. Why should prompts define the task clearly?

- A. To reduce ambiguity about what the AI should do

- B. To make the task harder
- C. To prevent AI from responding
- D. To remove context

Answer: A

53. Which prompt is clearest?

- A. "Make this better."
- B. "Rewrite this email in a polite and professional tone while keeping it under 100 words."
- C. "Fix it."
- D. "Change this."

Answer: B

54. What does context provide?

- A. Background information relevant to the task
- B. Computer memory
- C. Internet bandwidth
- D. Hardware specifications

Answer: A

55. Which prompt provides better context?

- A. "Write an email."
- B. "Write an email to a university professor requesting a two-day extension for an assignment."
- C. "Email professor."
- D. "Extension."

Answer: B

56. Why should the intended audience sometimes be specified?

- A. It helps determine language, tone and complexity
- B. It increases storage
- C. It changes the AI hardware
- D. It prevents output generation

Answer: A

57. Which prompt specifies an audience?

- A. "Explain machine learning to a beginner."
- B. "Explain machine learning."
- C. "Machine learning."
- D. "Tell me something."

Answer: A

58. What is an output constraint?

- A. A requirement that limits or structures the response
- B. A hardware limitation
- C. A network connection
- D. A database rule

Answer: A

59. Which is an output constraint?

- A. "Use exactly five bullet points."
- B. "Explain it."
- C. "Tell me more."
- D. "Do something."

Answer: A

60. Why specify output length?

- A. To control the amount of information generated
- B. To increase processor speed
- C. To eliminate context
- D. To make AI stop working

Answer: A

61. Which prompt requests a structured output?

- A. "Return the information in a table with columns: Name, Age and Department."
- B. "Tell me about employees."
- C. "Employees."
- D. "Give information."

Answer: A

62. What is an example in a prompt used for?

- A. Demonstrating the desired behavior or output pattern
- B. Increasing RAM
- C. Connecting to Wi-Fi
- D. Replacing instructions

Answer: A

63. What is few-shot prompting?

- A. Providing a small number of examples to guide the model
- B. Providing no instructions
- C. Using a camera
- D. Training computer hardware

Answer: A

64. What is zero-shot prompting?

- A. Asking the model to perform a task without providing examples
- B. Giving 100 examples
- C. Giving only incorrect examples
- D. Training a model from scratch

Answer: A

65. What is one-shot prompting?

- A. Providing one example to guide the task
- B. Providing zero examples
- C. Providing 100 examples

D. Providing only background information

Answer: A

66. What is a counterexample?

- A. An example showing what should not happen or what does not satisfy the requirement
- B. A successful output only
- C. A programming language
- D. A database record

Answer: A

67. Why can counterexamples be useful?

- A. They clarify boundaries and undesirable behavior
- B. They always guarantee correctness
- C. They eliminate context
- D. They make prompts meaningless

Answer: A

68. Which instruction is a counterexample?

- A. "Do not include technical jargon."
- B. "Use simple language."
- C. "Write five bullets."
- D. "Use a table."

Answer: A

69. What is a rubric?

- A. A set of criteria used to evaluate an output
- B. A programming compiler
- C. A database
- D. An operating system

Answer: A

70. Why use a rubric with AI outputs?

- A. To assess whether the response meets defined criteria
- B. To increase internet speed
- C. To replace all prompts
- D. To prevent AI from generating output

Answer: A

71. Which is a useful rubric criterion?

- A. Accuracy
- B. Relevance
- C. Clarity
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

72. Which prompt asks AI to evaluate its output against criteria?

- A. "Check the response for accuracy, relevance and clarity and revise if necessary."
- B. "Write something."
- C. "Answer."
- D. "Explain."

Answer: A

73. What is comparison prompting?

- A. Asking AI to compare alternatives using specified criteria
- B. Asking AI to restart
- C. Comparing computer hardware only
- D. Removing all options

Answer: A

74. Which is a comparison prompt?

- A. "Compare Python and Java based on syntax, performance and ease of learning."
- B. "Tell me Python."
- C. "Java."
- D. "Explain programming."

Answer: A

75. Why should comparison criteria be specified?

- A. To make the comparison focused and consistent
- B. To make the response random
- C. To eliminate differences
- D. To prevent comparison

Answer: A

76. What is task decomposition?

- A. Breaking a complex task into smaller manageable tasks
- B. Combining unrelated tasks
- C. Removing instructions
- D. Deleting the prompt

Answer: A

77. Why is task decomposition useful?

- A. It can make complex workflows easier to manage and evaluate
- B. It always makes AI faster
- C. It removes the need for context
- D. It guarantees perfect results

Answer: A

78. Which is an example of task decomposition?

- A. Research → outline → draft → review → revise
- B. Write everything without instructions
- C. Ask one vague question
- D. Remove all intermediate steps

Answer: A

79. A multi-step prompt workflow can be useful for:

- A. Complex tasks
- B. Simple greetings only
- C. Hardware repair only
- D. Internet configuration only

Answer: A

80. What should happen after evaluating an AI response?

- A. Revise the prompt if necessary
- B. Always accept it
- C. Always reject it
- D. Delete the AI tool

Answer: A

81. Which approach is most effective for improving prompts?

- A. Test, evaluate and iterate
- B. Never test
- C. Randomly change everything
- D. Remove all requirements

Answer: A

82. What is ambiguity in a prompt?

- A. A lack of clear meaning or interpretation
- B. A specific requirement
- C. A clear output format
- D. A useful example

Answer: A

83. Which prompt is ambiguous?

- A. "Write a short report."
- B. "Write a 500-word report about renewable energy for undergraduate students."
- C. "Return five bullet points."
- D. "Use formal English."

Answer: A

84. How can ambiguity be reduced?

- A. Add specific requirements and context
- B. Remove all details
- C. Use vague language
- D. Avoid defining the goal

Answer: A

85. Which instruction defines tone?

- A. "Use a formal and professional tone."

- B. "Write 200 words."
- C. "Use a table."
- D. "Give three examples."

Answer: A

86. Which instruction defines audience?

- A. "Write for beginners with no programming experience."
- B. "Use 300 words."
- C. "Use bullet points."
- D. "Give examples."

Answer: A

87. Which instruction defines format?

- A. "Present the answer as a numbered list."
- B. "Explain simply."
- C. "Write for students."
- D. "Focus on accuracy."

Answer: A

88. Which instruction defines scope?

- A. "Discuss only the advantages and disadvantages of electric vehicles."
- B. "Write clearly."
- C. "Use examples."
- D. "Be professional."

Answer: A

89. What happens when a prompt contains contradictory instructions?

- A. The AI may produce an inconsistent or unexpected response
- B. The AI always resolves them perfectly
- C. The prompt becomes automatically better
- D. The output is guaranteed to be correct

Answer: A

90. Which prompt has a contradiction?

- A. "Write exactly 50 words and provide a 500-word explanation."
- B. "Write 50 words."
- C. "Use five bullet points."
- D. "Write for beginners."

Answer: A

91. What is prompt refinement?

- A. Improving a prompt based on observed output quality
- B. Deleting the AI model
- C. Changing computer hardware
- D. Removing all context

Answer: A

92. Which is a good refinement? Initial prompt: 'Explain databases.' Improved prompt:

- A. "Explain databases to beginners using three real-world examples and five key terms."
- B. "Databases."
- C. "Explain something."
- D. "Write."

Answer: A

93. Which technique is useful when a task has many requirements?

- A. Explicitly list the requirements
- B. Hide the requirements
- C. Remove the task
- D. Use unrelated examples

Answer: A

94. Why can numbered instructions be useful?

- A. They organize multiple requirements clearly
- B. They increase CPU speed
- C. They guarantee factual accuracy
- D. They eliminate the need for context

Answer: A

95. Which prompt is better for extracting information?

- A. "Tell me about this document."
- B. "Extract the document's title, author, publication date and three key findings in a table."
- C. "Document."
- D. "Summarize."

Answer: B

96. Which technique helps maintain consistency across repeated tasks?

- A. Reusable prompt templates
- B. Random prompts
- C. Removing instructions
- D. Changing requirements every time

Answer: A

97. Which is the best approach when an AI response contains irrelevant information?

- A. Narrow the scope and explicitly state what to include and exclude
- B. Add unrelated information
- C. Remove the task
- D. Make the prompt more vague

Answer: A

98. Which workflow represents effective prompt iteration?

- A. Prompt → Output → Evaluate → Refine → Test again
- B. Prompt → Accept everything
- C. Prompt → Delete → Stop

D. Prompt → Ignore output

Answer: A

99. Which combination generally produces a stronger prompt?

- A. Context + intent + constraints + output format
- B. Ambiguity + missing context
- C. Random examples + contradictory instructions
- D. Very short instructions with no goal

Answer: A

100. Which statement best summarizes effective prompt engineering?

- A. Write the longest possible prompt
- B. Give clear goals, relevant context, useful examples, explicit constraints, evaluate the output, and iterate
- C. Always use the same prompt
- D. Trust every AI response without checking it

Answer: B